ARKO BANERJEE

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Behavioral Economics · Development Economics · Computational Modelling & Econometrics · Epistemic Game Theory

RESEARCH & FIELD EXPERIENCE

Research Intern — Abhijit Sen Rural Internship (ASRI), National Foundation for India *Jun – Aug 2026*

Nationally selected cohort · Placed with School for Democracy (SFD), the educational arm of MKSS, Bhim Block, Rajsamand District, Rajasthan · Delhi induction (Jun 14–20) + 30-day rural fieldwork (Jun 21 – Jul 20)

- Studied whether rural households knew that VB-GRAM-G (effective Jul 1, 2026) had replaced MGNREGA's legal work-demand guarantee; ran 55 household interviews, 6 focus group discussions, 4 panchayat-official interviews, and 2 case studies across 3 villages during the exact policy transition window.
- Central finding: a direct official-household mismatch — all 4 panchayat officials reported active multi-channel communication of the change, while most households reported no meeting, a rumour, or nothing at all.
- Coded a secondary finding on pre-NREGA coping strategies as a historical counterfactual (44% of respondents gave a specific comparison); authored final report for NFI submission (Aug 2026).

COURSES & CERTIFICATIONS

IGC-G²LM | LIC Development Economics — International Growth Centre & IZA · Certificate *May – Jul 2026*

Profs. Oriana Bandiera & Robin Burgess (LSE) · Impact Evaluation: Prof. Stefano Caria (Warwick) · Weekly graduate-level seminar, 11 sessions

Coursework: GDP mismeasurement & night-lights proxies, RCT design (ITT vs. LATE, compliance & attrition), poverty traps & the Lewis model, microfinance & credit-market failures, firm growth constraints & returns to capital, labor market experiments

IBM Data Analysis Professional Certificate — Coursera / IBM *In Progress, 2026*

Python, Tools for Data Science, Data Science foundations · 4 of 12 modules complete

PROJECTS

Econ Speech Tone Analyser — NLP / Computational Economics — *2026*

Python NLP tool classifying Fed, RBI, and ECB speeches (Hawkish / Dovish / Neutral) via domain-specific lexicon analysis, benchmarked against actual rate decisions (2021–2024).

- Finding: Fed speeches shift tone 4–8 weeks before rate decisions — consistent with forward guidance theory.
- Academic grounding: Loughran & McDonald (2011); Hansen, McMahon & Prat (2018); Gürkaynak, Sack & Swanson (2005).

Tech: Python, NLTK, textstat, pandas, Plotly, Streamlit GitHub · Live App

GDP & Inflation Explorer — Data Engineering / Macroeconomics — *2026*

Interactive dashboard pulling live World Bank API data across 45 countries — GDP, per capita income, inflation, and growth trends with dual-axis overlays and CSV export.

Tech: Python, pandas, Plotly, Streamlit, World Bank API GitHub · Live App

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Economics — IISER Bhopal (Institute of National Importance, Govt. of India) *Aug 2025 – Jun 2029*

CPI (Year 1): 7.67 · Coursework: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Linear Algebra, Calculus, Computing (C), Econometrics I, Multivariable Calculus, Groups & Symmetry

Class XII — Mahesh PU College (FIITJEE Affiliate) *2025 | 81.5%*

Class X — Delhi Public School, Electronic City *2023 | 94.2%*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming	Python (pandas, numpy, matplotlib), R (tidyverse), C, C++, Java, HTML
Data & Analysis	SQL, Excel, Jupyter Notebooks, statistical analysis
NLP & Modelling	NLTK, textstat, Streamlit, Plotly, lexicon-based text classification
Languages	English (proficient) · Bengali & Hindi (native) · German (A1)

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

Point of Contact — Debating Society, IISER Bhopal *2025 – Present*

- Coordination lead for debate events; competitive parliamentary argumentation across policy, philosophy, and current affairs.

Core Committee Member — Economics Club, IISER Bhopal *Jun 2026 – Present*

- Economic analysis of alumni career outcomes; produced outreach content for club communications.

Core Committee Member — Mathematics Club, IISER Bhopal *Jun 2026 – Present*

- Handled club correspondence and email outreach; supported team logistics and on-ground coordination for club events.